Wenchang Wang

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Education

Northwestern University — Evanston, IL, USA
Ph.D. in Media, Technology, and Society (MTS) — Sep 2026 – Jun 2031 (Expected)
Advisor: Associate Professor Emőke-Ágnes Horvát
Research interests: User behavior under policy changes, big data analysis, computational social science

Peking University — Shenzhen, Guangdong
M.A. in Journalism and Communication; Minor in Economics — Aug 2023 – Jun 2026
Advisor: Assistant Professor Zhuo Chen
Minor includes exchange study at the University of Cologne, Germany

University of Cologne — Cologne, Germany
Exchange Student in Economics and Information Science — Oct 2024 – Mar 2025
Exchange coursework completed during graduate study at Peking University

Soochow University — Suzhou, Jiangsu
B.E. in Mechanical and Electronic Engineering — Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

Honors, Scholarships, and Grants

Awards

- Best Faculty Paper, ICA 76th Annual Conference, 2026
- Promising Student Paper, ICA 75th Annual Conference, 2025
- Award of Scientific Research, Peking University, 2024
- Top Student Paper, AEJMC 107th Annual Conference, 2024

Scholarships

- National Scholarship of China, 2025
- Peking University Graduate Scholarship, 2023–2025

Grants

- International Communication Association Annual Conference Travel Grant, 2026
- National Social Science Fund of China (Team Member), 2025
- International Communication Association Annual Conference Travel Grant, 2025
- Peking University Conference Travel Grant, 2024

Research and Publications

** indicates equal contributions; † indicates corresponding author.*

Preprints (Not Peer-reviewed)

arXiv
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Song, Y. (2026). **Same Sentence, Different Construct: Identity-Swapped Rationales Reveal Measurement Non-Invariance in LLM Hate Speech Classifiers**. *arXiv:2611.02491.*

arXiv
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Song, Y. (2026). **When the Text Is Silent: Memory Shortcuts and the Validity of LLM Annotation under Evidence Insufficiency**. *arXiv:2611.02273.*

arXiv
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (2026). **The Hidden Costs of Gatekeeping in Open Science: Quasi-Experimental Evidence from arXiv's Endorsement Policy Tightening**. *arXiv:2610.33980.*

Journal Articles

HCR
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Chen, Z. (Conditional accept). **Platform ownership change and user response**. *Human Communication Research.*

JEMS
2ND AUTHOR

Chen, Z., **Wang, W.**, Zhou, H., & Li, S. (2025). **Pathways of computational communication research in China: A network analysis perspective**. *Journal of Educational Media Studies (in Chinese).* † Corresponding author.

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

CSCW'26
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Song, Y. (2026). **The Productivity–Entry Paradox: AI Coding Tools Boost Output but Do Not Lower Barriers to Open-Source Contribution**. *Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion'26), Salt Lake City, UT, USA.*

CSCW'26
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Song, Y. (2026). **Do LLMs Read for Free? Auditing the Open Access Bias in AI-Mediated Science**. *Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion'26), Salt Lake City, UT, USA.*

Research in Progress

CSCW'27
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (Under review). **Dependabot and deliberation on GitHub**. *ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW'27).*

ICWSM'27
CO-1ST

He, H.*, **Wang, W.***, & Chen, Z. (Under review). **Machine sanctions and contributor participation on Wikipedia**. *International Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM'27).*

WWW'27
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (Under review). **Rebuttal dynamics in online discussion trees**. *The Web Conference (WWW'27).*

WWW'27
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (Under review). **Temporal sampling and measurement in web platform data**. *The Web Conference (WWW'27).*

WWW'27
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (Under review). **Reply controls and conversation structure on Bluesky**. *The Web Conference (WWW'27).*

WWW'27
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Chen, Z. (Under review). **Vicarious deterrence in Reddit user–community networks**. *The Web Conference (WWW'27).*

ICS
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Chen, Z. (Under review). **Sexualized visual strategies and fitness influencer growth**. *Information, Communication & Society.*

Peer-Reviewed Conference Presentations

ICA'26
2ND AUTHOR

Chen, Z., & **Wang, W.** (2026, June 4–8). **How Travel Videos Shape Intergroup Perception? The Spillover Effect of Mediated Intergroup Contact**. *2026 ICA 76th Conference, Cape Town, South Africa. Best Faculty Paper Award.*

NCA'25
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (2025, November 19–23). **Fine-Tuned Large Language Models: Superior Annotator in Computational Social Science**. *2025 NCA 111th Conference, Denver, USA.*

ICCC'25
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., Chen, Z., Hu, Y., & Dong, Q. (2025, October 25–26). **Platform Ownership Change and the Heterogeneous Responses of Peer Production Contributors with Different Motivations**. *2025 Annual Conference on Intelligent and Computational Communication, Beijing, China.*

IC²S²'25
1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (2025, July 22–24). **Exposure and Engagement: Analyzing the Impact of Visual Strategies by Fitness Influencers on Social Media**. *2025 IC²S² Conference, Norrköping, Sweden.*

ICA'25 1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., Zhou, H., Xia, D., Li, S., & Ma, Y. (2025, June 12–16). **When Sexual Education Becomes the Paradise of Discrimination, Stigma, and Sexual Humor: A Discussion and Empirical Examination of Health Information Dissemination and Interaction Patterns in Weibo Community**. *2025 ICA 75th Conference, Denver, USA.*

ICA'25 2ND AUTHOR

Li, S., **Wang, W.**, & Zhou, H. (2025, June 12–16). **Towards Seriousness or Entertainment? An Empirical Analysis of the Digital Transformation of The New York Times**. *2025 ICA 75th Conference, Denver, USA.*

ICA'25 2ND AUTHOR

Zhou, H., **Wang, W.**, & Li, S. (2025, June 12–16). **Quantifying Academic Capital: Examining the Evolution of Inequality in China's Communication Research Production**. *2025 ICA 75th Conference, Denver, USA. Promising Student Paper Award in the Information Systems Division.*

ICCC'24 2ND AUTHOR

Chen, Z., & **Wang, W.** (2024, November 9–10). **Seeing is Believing?: How Travel Videos Shape Foreign Attitude Toward China**. *2024 Annual Conference on Intelligent and Computational Communication, Hangzhou, China.*

AEJMC'24 1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., & Xia, D. (2024, August 8–11). **"The Invisible Poor in the Eyes of LLMs" — A Study on Stereotypes in Large Language Models**. *2024 AEJMC 107th Conference, Philadelphia, USA.*

AEJMC'24 1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W., Liu, Y., Lin, Z., & Ouyang, W. (2024, August 8–11). **Focusing on Minority Groups: A Quantitative Study on the Attitudes of Diverse Minority Groups towards ChatGPT**. *2024 AEJMC 107th Conference, Philadelphia, USA. Top Paper Award.*

IAMCR'24 1ST AUTHOR

Wang, W. (2024, June 30–July 4). **"Are There Really No Poor People on Social Media?" — A Study on Platform Visibility**. *2024 IAMCR Conference, Christchurch, New Zealand.*

Research Experience

Telemarketing and Success Rate Project — Peking University · 2024

Data Annotation with Large Language Models — Peking University · 2025

Academic Service

Reviewer

International Communication Association (ICA), 2025–2026
International Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM), 2026
National Communication Association (NCA), 2025
Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), 2025

Teaching

Teaching Assistant · Statistics in Social Research (Prof. Zhuo Chen), Peking University

Teaching Assistant · Science, Media and the Public (Prof. Luye Bao), Peking University

Skills and Interests

Data Science: Proficient in Python, R, and Julia; basic knowledge of Matlab and C. Machine learning model construction, deep learning model fine-tuning, web data mining, and data analysis.
Academic Skills: Data visualization using Python, R, and Julia; document preparation using LaTeX.
Language: TOEFL 103.
Interests: Skilled guitarist and jazz drummer; performed at Peking University's "Mirror Lake Night" and School of Chemistry and Biological Technology annual gala.

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